

Before You Hit Send

The AI editing checklist for everything you write with Claude

Claude can draft a great email, report, or proposal. But "great" isn't the same as "ready to send." This checklist catches the things that make AI-assisted writing sound like AI-assisted writing — and the mistakes that erode trust when they slip through.

Does It Sound Like You?

- Read it out loud. If you stumble or cringe, rewrite that part
- Kill AI-isms: "I'd be happy to," "Let's dive in," "Certainly," "It's worth noting," "In conclusion"
- Check for words you'd never actually say — they're Claude's vocabulary, not yours
- Vary the sentence length. AI tends to write in uniform medium-length sentences
- Make sure the opening doesn't sound like a robot clearing its throat

Is It Actually Correct?

- Verify any numbers, dates, or statistics
- Check that names are spelled correctly (Claude sometimes invents confident misspellings)
- Confirm any claims about policies, regulations, or company specifics
- Make sure links work and point where they should
- If it references previous conversations, verify those actually happened

Is It the Right Length?

- Cut anything that restates the obvious — Claude loves to explain things the reader already knows
- Remove the warm-up paragraph if the real point starts in paragraph two
- Delete the summary paragraph if the email is already short enough to read in one pass
- Check: could you cut 30% and lose nothing? If yes, do it

Is the Tone Right?

- Match the formality to the relationship — is this your boss, a client, a colleague, a friend?
- Check for unearned enthusiasm. Claude often sounds more excited than the situation warrants
- Make sure urgency or sensitivity is calibrated — AI defaults to even-keeled, which can read as dismissive on sensitive topics
- If you're delivering bad news or pushback, make sure it doesn't sound chipper

Will It Do What You Want?

- Is the ask clear? The reader should know exactly what you want them to do
- Is the deadline stated if there is one?
- Is it clear who needs to respond and who's just FYI?
- Would you know what to do if you received this? If not, rewrite the ending

The 30-Second Version

Pin this somewhere visible:

1	Read it out loud
2	Kill the AI-isms
3	Check the facts
4	Cut the fluff
5	Match the tone to the relationship
6	Make the ask unmistakable

AI-isms to Kill on Sight

If you see these, Claude wrote them, not you:

"Certainly!"	"I'd be happy to..."	"Great question!"
"Let's dive in"	"It's worth noting that..."	"In today's fast-paced..."
"Leverage" (as a verb)	"Holistic approach"	"Moving forward"
"Circle back"	"At the end of the day"	"It goes without saying"

This resource is a companion to Chapters 2 and 10 of Creating with Claude: A Practical Guide for Everyone. Chapter 2 teaches the iteration process that produces better first drafts. Chapter 10 helps you build a system so your quality bar stays high. Get the book at marquepublishing.com.